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CART 315 Digital Game Prototype

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November 5th, 2026

# Prototype Reading Reflection

The aspect of Lim et al.'s reading that I found particularly intriguing was the description of the prototypes as both filters and manifestations of the design ideas. Filters assist the designers in focusing on particular aspects of the design, while manifestations convert design concepts into something tangible. The amount of decision making required for design became apparent to me, as well as how the process allows us to choose some elements and reject others. Another intriguing feature about prototypes is that they give designers an opportunity to explore the various possibilities, rather than simply test whether the idea works.

The concept I most related to is that of a prototype not needing to be fully functional or refined in order to be useful. This is relevant to my own experience in building wireframes to design games, in which I often find myself wanting to have all aspects of a screen fully completed before trying it out. However, what the reading taught me was that a less complicated design is better for discovering problems in navigation and game mechanics.

The idea that I felt connected to was the notion that even though a prototype isn't complete and perfect, it still serves its purpose. This is particularly applicable to my experience with wireframe construction for video game development, since at times I catch myself desiring to have all aspects of the screen done before testing it out. But after reading, I realized that sometimes a simpler approach to the process of wireframe construction makes for a better way of finding flaws in navigations, interactions, and mechanics of the game. For instance, during the creation of various phases of the social deduction game for one of my classes this semester, I can use simple wireframes to understand player navigation between action phase, voting, and voting results.

All in all, this reading has made me realize the importance of not worrying too much about completing a design prematurely. It has made me appreciate the fact that design is all about decision-making, questioning, and the willingness to change one's mind in accordance with the discoveries made during the process. Early prototypes have become a means of discovering a design for me.